

FREE · PLAIN LANGUAGE · EVERY CHAPTER OF LIFE

the money map.

whatever you're going through, it starts in the same place: footing that's yours. then your chapter's first three steps. then where every dollar goes. start anywhere — done beats perfect.

first, get your own footing.

five things that should be in your name at every stage.
check them off one at a time, smallest first.

1	an account that's yours alone money you can reach without asking anyone. the single most important line on this page.	DO THIS open checking or savings in your name only, at a bank you picked. send part of every paycheck there.
2	copies of your documents proof of who you are, ready in an afternoon.	DO THIS ID, passport, social security card, birth certificate, tax returns, lease or deed, insurance — copies, stored where only you can reach.
3	a cushion that's yours what lets you handle a surprise — or a change — on your own terms.	DO THIS build it in stages (below) in a high-yield savings account in your name.
4	credit in your own name a score that's yours, not borrowed from someone else's card.	DO THIS be the primary on one card, autopay the full balance, and check your free reports at annualcreditreport.com .
5	one number you know what comes in, what goes out, what you're worth.	DO THIS write down monthly take-home, monthly essentials, and net worth (own minus owe). check it once a month.

THE CUSHION, IN STAGES — EACH ONE IS A REAL WIN

\$500 covers a deductible or a vet visit	\$1,000 most one-off emergencies	1 month of rent, food, bills, insurance	3–6 mo. more if you're the only income
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FIND YOUR CHAPTER

whatever you're going through — here are your **first three steps.**

find yours, do step 1 this week. that's it. the rest can wait until you're ready.

i'm getting divorced

- 1** copy every statement + 3 years of tax returns
- 2** open an account in your name only; pull your credit report
- 3** list what you own and owe; check every beneficiary before signing

i need to leave — quietly

- 1** safety first: call 800-799-7233 or text START to 88788
- 2** copy your documents; keep them where only you can reach
- 3** start money that's only yours — even \$20 at a time

my partner died

- 1** most big decisions can wait a few months
- 2** order several certified death certificates
- 3** call social security about survivor benefits; check beneficiaries

i'm going back to work

- 1** write down what you did while away — it counts
- 2** know your number before the first interview
- 3** negotiate the first offer; every raise builds on it

i'm starting over from zero

- 1** an account in your name + your free credit reports
- 2** build credit on purpose: a secured card, paid in full
- 3** cushion in stages: \$500 → \$1,000 → one month

i'm starting a business

- 1** test the idea; keep business money separate from day one
- 2** sole proprietor or LLC, plus a free EIN from the IRS
- 3** set aside ~25–30% of what you earn for taxes

i'm raising kids on my own

- 1** file head of household; claim up to \$2,200 per child
- 2** name a guardian in a will; check beneficiaries
- 3** build a bigger cushion — you're the only income

i came into money

- 1** park it in high-yield savings and wait 30 days
- 2** pay off high-interest debt first
- 3** then decide — with a fee-only advisor if it's big

more chapters — first job, first lease, a job offer, caring for a parent, a surprise bill, divorcing after 50 — with links to go deeper.

multiplata.com/start.html →

THE SPLIT

give every dollar a job
before it disappears.

one split for every paycheck, one for money that shows up extra. bend them to your life
— but bend joy first, never future-you.

